ME 5309 – Mid-Semester Examination: ANSWER SHEET

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Questions attempted: Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4

Question 1

Given: sensor 1280 px wide, pixel pitch p = 5 µm (square), lens f = 16 mm, standoff Z = 400 mm; force sensor 10 mV/N, 12-bit ADC over 0–5 V; plant $\dot{x} = -2x + u$ with zero-order hold, T = 0.1 s.

(a) (i) $f_x = f/p = 16\text{ mm} / 5\ \mu\text{m} =$ **3200 px**.

(ii) Sensor width = 1280 × 5 µm = 6.4 mm; FOV = $W_s \cdot Z/f = 6.4 \times 400/16 =$ **160 mm**.

(b) Assumptions: ideal 12-bit ADC (4096 codes), the full 0–5 V range is used, no offset or gain error, and sensor noise is below one LSB so quantisation sets the limit.

Voltage step: 1 LSB = $V_{FS}/2^N = 5\text{ V}/4096 = 1.2207\times10^{-3}$ V = 1.2207 mV.

The sensor maps force to voltage by V = S·F with S = 10 mV/N, so $\Delta F_{min} = \Delta V/S = 1.2207$ mV / (10 mV/N) = 0.12207 N. $\mathbf{\Delta F_{min} \approx 0.122\ N}$. (Using 4095 steps instead of 4096 codes gives 0.1221 N, the same at 3 s.f.)

(c) $F = e^{AT}$, $G = A^{-1}(F - I)B$. Taking T = 0.01 s.

$F = e^{-0.02} =$ **0.9802**.

$G = (0.9802 - 1)/(-2) =$ **0.0099**.

Sanity check: a 160 mm field of view across 1280 pixels is plausible for a 400 mm standoff and a 16 mm lens.

Question 2

Given: J = 0.02 kg·m², b = 0.05 N·m·s/rad, m = 1 kg, ℓ = 0.25 m, g = 9.81 m/s². So mgℓ = 1 × 9.81 × 0.25 = 2.4525 N·m (used throughout).

(a) The model is second order, so I choose the position and velocity as states: $x = [x_1, x_2]^T = [\theta, \dot{\theta}]^T$, with input τ.

Rewriting $J\ddot{\theta} + b\dot{\theta} + mg\ell \sin\theta = \tau$ gives the nonlinear state-space model: $\dot{x}_1 = x_2$, $\dot{x}_2 = (1/J)(\tau - b\,x_2 - mg\ell \sin x_1)$, i.e. $\dot{x} = f(x, \tau)$.

Equilibria for constant τ_0 need $\dot{x} = 0$: the first equation gives $x_2 = 0$, and the second then gives $mg\ell \sin\theta_e = \tau_0$, i.e. $\sin\theta_e = \tau_0/(mg\ell)$.

This has a solution only if $|\tau_0/(mg\ell)| \le 1$, so $\mathbf{|\tau_0| \le mg\ell = 2.4525\ N\cdot m}$. For $|\tau_0| < mg\ell$ there are two equilibria per revolution (θ_e and $\pi - \theta_e$); at $|\tau_0| = mg\ell$ they merge, and beyond it the joint cannot be held statically.

(b) The equilibrium at $\theta_e = 60°$ needs the torque $\tau_e = mg\ell \sin 60° = 2.4525 \times 0.8660 = 2.124$ N·m. Define deviations $\delta x = x - x_e$ with $x_e = [60°, 0]^T$ and $\delta\tau = \tau - \tau_e$; then $\delta\dot{x} \approx A\,\delta x + B\,\delta\tau$ with the Jacobians evaluated at the equilibrium.

$\partial f_1/\partial x = [0, 1]$. $\partial f_2/\partial x_1 = -(mg\ell/J)\cos x_1 = -(2.4525/0.02)(0.5) = -122.625 \times 0.5 = -61.31$ (s^{-2}). $\partial f_2/\partial x_2 = -b/J = -0.05/0.02 = -2.5\ s^{-1}$.

A = [0, 1; −61.31, −2.5], and since $\partial f_2/\partial\tau = 1/J = 50$, **B = [0; 50]**.

Check: the characterstic equation $\lambda^2 + 2.5\lambda + 61.31 = 0$ gives $\lambda = -1.25 \pm 7.73j$, a lightly damped stable oscillation, as expected for a pendulum hanging near-vertical (60° below the downward vertical).

(c) At rest $\dot{\theta} = \ddot{\theta} = 0$: $K_p(\theta_d - \theta_{ss}) = mg\ell \sin\theta_{ss} = 2.4525 \sin\theta_{ss}$. At $\theta_d = 90°$ the right side ≠ 0 while the left side = 0, so the joint cannot rest at θ_d.

With $\sin\theta_{ss} \approx 1$: $\theta_d - \theta_{ss} = 2.4525/50 = 0.00491$ rad = **0.281°**.

(d) Stedy state: $\dot{\theta} = \ddot{\theta} = 0$ and the control law gives $\tau = K_p(\theta_d - \theta_{ss}) + mg\ell \sin\theta_{ss}$. Plugging into the plant, $mg\ell \sin\theta_{ss} = K_p(\theta_d - \theta_{ss}) + mg\ell \sin\theta_{ss}$, so $K_p(\theta_d - \theta_{ss}) = 0$ and **$\theta_{ss} = \theta_d$: steady-state error is zero**.

Poles: linearise the closed loop about θ_d. Before compensation, $J\ddot{\theta} + (b + K_d)\dot{\theta} + (K_p + mg\ell \cos\theta_d)\,\delta\theta = 0$, characteristic polynomial $J\lambda^2 + (b + K_d)\lambda + K_p + mg\ell \cos\theta_d$. After compensation the added term $mg\ell \sin\theta$ cancels the plant's gravity term exactly, leaving $J\lambda^2 + (b + K_d)\lambda + K_p$.

The two differ only by $mg\ell \cos\theta_d$, and for $\theta_d = 90°$ this is $2.4525 \times 0 = 0$. So **the closed-loop poles are unchanged** at this operating angle. I should stress this is because $\cos 90° = 0$; if θ_d were, say, 60°, the compensaton would raise the stiffness by 61.3×0.02... i.e. it would move the poles.

Question 3

Given: A = [0, 1; 0, −2], B = [0; 1], C = [1, 0], f_s = 1 kHz so the sample time is $T = 1/f_s$ = 1 ms.

(a) (1) Taking the difference of two readings amplifies noise.

(2) The high frequency noise in the encoder signal gets magnified when we subtract successive readings and divide by a small T.

(b) The analogue prototype is the first-order low-pass $H(s) = \omega_c/(s + \omega_c)$ with $\omega_c = 2\pi f_c = 2\pi \times 20 = 125.66$ rad/s. The bilinear (Tustin) transform replaces s by $(2/T)(z - 1)/(z + 1)$ with $T = 1/f_s = 0.001$ s.

Define $a = \omega_c T/2 = 125.66 \times 0.001/2 = 0.062832$. Then $H(z) = \omega_c / [(2/T)(z-1)/(z+1) + \omega_c] = a(z + 1) / [(1 + a)\,z - (1 - a)] = a(1 + z^{-1}) / [(1 + a) - (1 - a)\,z^{-1}]$.

Dividing through by $(1 + a)$: $a/(1 + a) = 0.062832/1.062832 = 0.059117$ and $(1 - a)/(1 + a) = 0.937168/1.062832 = 0.881767$. Hence with u = differenced signal and y = filtered velocity: **$y_k = 0.05912\,(u_k + u_{k-1}) + 0.88177\,y_{k-1}$**. (Frequency pre-warping is neglected since $f_c \ll f_s/2$.)

Verification of the DC gain: set u and y constant (z = 1): $y = 2(0.05912)u + 0.88177\,y \Rightarrow y(1 - 0.88177) = 0.11824\,u \Rightarrow y/u = 0.11824/0.11823 = 1.000$. In general $H(1) = 2a/[(1 + a) - (1 - a)] = 2a/2a = 1$ exactly, so the steady-state output equals the commanded input ✓.

(c) $A - LC = [-\ell_1, 1; -\ell_2, -2]$; characterstic polynomial $\det(sI - A + LC) = (s + \ell_1)(s + 2) + \ell_2 = s^2 + (2 + \ell_1)s + (2\ell_1 + \ell_2)$.

Desired $(s + 10)^2 = s^2 + 20s + 100$. Then $2 + \ell_1 = 20 \Rightarrow \ell_1 = 18$, and $2\ell_1 + \ell_2 = 100 \Rightarrow \ell_2 = 100 - 18 = 82$.

$L = [18, 82]^T$.

(d) Advantage of the observer that no filter of this kind can give: the obsever is driven by both the measurement y and the model with the actual input u, so it predicts the motion between samples. The velocity estimate therefore has little or no phase lag. The low-pass filter on differenced data, by contrast, always pays a lag of about $1/(2\pi f_c) = 8$ ms for its noice rejection, a trade-off it cannot escape. In addition the observer gives all states, and can be augmented with a disturbance state (e.g. unknown load torque) which no filter on θ can estimat.

Circumstance where the filter is safer: when the plant model is poorly known or changes during operation, for example an unknown payload, varying friction, contact with the environment, or acuator saturation making u differ from the commanded value. The observer propagates the wrong model so its estimate can be biased (and in the worst case unstable with the feedback loop), whereas the model-free filter just smooths what the encoder actually measures.

Question 4

Given: plant $\ddot{\theta} + a\dot{\theta} + c\theta = b\,u$ with $a = 2$, $c = 6$, $b = 1$; controller $u = N_{ff}\,r - k_1\theta - k_2\dot{\theta}$.

(a) Substitute the control law into the plant: $\ddot{\theta} + a\dot{\theta} + c\theta = b\,N_{ff}\,r - b\,k_1\,\theta - b\,k_2\,\dot{\theta}$. Moving the feedback terms to the left: $\ddot{\theta} + (a + b\,k_2)\,\dot{\theta} + (c + b\,k_1)\,\theta = b\,N_{ff}\,r$.

Numerically, $a + b\,k_2 = 2 + 2 = 4$ and $c + b\,k_1 = 6 + 2 = 8$, so the characteristic equation is $s^2 + 4s + 8 = 0$. Roots: $s = [-4 \pm \sqrt{(16 - 32)}]/2 = -2 \pm 2j$. They have negative real parts, so the loop is stable; $\omega_n = \sqrt{8} = 2.83$ rad/s and $\zeta = 4/(2 \times 2.83) = 0.707$.

Transfer function from r to θ: $T(s) = b\,N_{ff} / (s^2 + 4s + 8)$. DC gain ($s = 0$): $T(0) = N_{ff}/8$. For unity DC gain, $\mathbf{N_{ff} = 8}$. (Note that this is larger than 1 because the gravity-related stiffness c and the feedback k_1 both resist the displacement.)

(b) With the actual $b = 0.75$ and unchanged $N_{ff} = 8$, $k_1 = k_2 = 2$, the closed loop becomes $\ddot{\theta} + (a + bk_2)\dot{\theta} + (c + bk_1)\theta = bN_{ff}\,r$, i.e. $\ddot{\theta} + 3.5\dot{\theta} + 7.5\theta = 6\,r$.

For a unit step the steady state is found by setting derivatives to zero: $7.5\,\theta_{ss} = 6 \times 1$, so $\theta_{ss} = 6/7.5 = \mathbf{0.8}$.

Tracking error $= (r - \theta_{ss})/r \times 100\% = (1 - 0.8) \times 100 = \mathbf{20\%}$. A common mistake would be to say the output falls by the same 25% as the actuator gain; that is wrong here, because b also appears in the feedback stiffness $c + bk_1$, which decreases from 8 to 7.5 and partially compensates. The poles also change: $s^2 + 3.5s + 7.5 \rightarrow s = -1.75 \pm 2.11j$, still stable.

(c) Take the state $z = [\theta, \dot{\theta}, \xi]^T$. The plant gives $\ddot{\theta} = -a\dot{\theta} - c\theta + b\,u$ with $u = -k_1\theta - k_2\dot{\theta} + K_I\xi$, and $\dot{\xi} = r - \theta$. With $r = 0$ (r only shifts the equilibrium) the closed-loop matrix is $A_{cl} = [0, 1, 0; -(c + bk_1), -(a + bk_2), bK_I; -1, 0, 0]$.

Characteristic polynomial $\det(sI - A_{cl})$, expanding along the first row: $s\cdot[(s + a + bk_2)s - 0] + 1\cdot[(c + bk_1)s + bK_I] = s^3 + (a + bk_2)s^2 + (c + bk_1)s + bK_I$. **(Reuslt)**

Desiered poles -4 and $-2 \pm 2j$: $(s + 2 - 2j)(s + 2 + 2j) = (s + 2)^2 + 4 = s^2 + 4s + 8$. Multiply by $(s + 4)$: $s^3 + 4s^2 + 8s + 4s^2 + 16s + 32 = s^3 + 8s^2 + 24s + 32$.

Compare coefficients with $a = 2$, $b = 1$, $c = 6$: s^2: $2 + k_2 = 8 \Rightarrow \mathbf{k_2 = 6}$. s^1: $6 + k_1 = 24 \Rightarrow \mathbf{k_1 = 18}$. s^0: $b\,K_I = 32 \Rightarrow \mathbf{K_I = 32}$.

Check: all coefficients of the desired polynomial are positive and $(8)(24) = 192 > 32$, so Routh–Hurwitz confirms the three poles are in the left half plane ✓.

(d) The integrator keeps acumulating the error until the error becomes zero, so the steady-state error is zero whatever b and c are, if the loop is stable.

Failure mode: integrater windup when the acuator saturtes. Remedy: anti-windup, e.g. clamp the integrator.

Remark: with integral action the exact value of N_{ff} matters less because the integrator enforces tracking.